[METRIC]

A-A-2752
November 15, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INK, WRITING FOR FOUNTAIN AND DIP PENS

This Commercial Item Description is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies. This document supersedes Federal Specification TT-I-563, which is cancelled.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This commercial item description covers quick drying marker ink for use for fountain and dip pens.

1.2 Types. Type I . Washable
Type II. Permanent

1.3 Colors. The ink shall be furnished with ink of one of the following colors black, blue-black, blue, red, green or as specified in section 9 (Notes).

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Material. The manufacturer is given a wide latitude in the selection of materials and processes of manufacture provided the ink meets the requirements of this commercial item description.

2.2 Stability. There shall be little evidence of separation of the materials and no evidence of caking of the coloring matter in the ink.

2.3 Performance. The ink shall be in a smooth working condition. Ink writing shall present clear and legible characters of uniform intensity without evidence of feathering, smudging or offsetting.

2.4 Reaction. Writing ink shall remain stable when in contact with metal parts of the fountain pen or dip set.

2.5 Washability. Type I only shall not leave a stain on the test fabric when tested in accordance with section 3.6.

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2.6 Fading. Writing shall be legible after being exposed as specified in section 3.5.

2.7 Resistance to water. (Type II only) Writing tested in accordance with 3.7 shall not smear or smudge.

2.8 Shelf Life. The items shall have a shelf life of one year after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling.

2.9 Workmanship. The ink shall be free from defects or imperfections of manufacture which may affect its durability, appearance, serviceability or present a hazard to the user.

3. TEST METHODS

3.1 Performance. This test shall be performed with a fountain pen normally used for this type of ink. Fill the pen. On a firm surface place a sheet of bond paper and proceed to make 10 letters. After 10 minutes examine the letters for legibility, intensity, smearing and feathering.

3.2 Drying time. Writing prepared as specified in 3.1 shall be allowed to dry for 5 seconds at room temperature. Place a sheet of white chemical wood writing paper over the markings. Place a hundred gram weight on the edge of the paper and draw the sheet of paper slowly across the markings. Examine the paper for smudging.

3.3 Clogging. After the writing test described in 3.1 replace the fountain pen cap. Keep the pen for five days in a horizontal position in a room or cabinet at room temperature. At the conclusion of this period, repeat the writing test.

3.4 Reaction to metal parts. Immerse for one week a common steel pen point in a sample of ink. At the end of the week, the pen point shall be in a serviceable condition so that it may be used for writing. The pen point may be slightly etched, corroded or pitted.

3.5 Fading. Expose a sample of writing performed as in section 3.1 to the radiation of a carbon arc lamp such as Fade-ometer type FDA-R or its equivalent, 48 hours at a distance of 25 cm. Examine for legibility.

3.6 Washability. (Type I only) Cut a piece of white cotton broadcloth ten square cm. Place 10 drops of ink on the cloth and rub into the cloth. Allow cloth to dry for one hour. Wash in a normal commercial washing machine on hot water (60 degree C) and durable fabric setting without bleach using a standard household detergent. Allow the cloth to dry and examine for stain.

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3.7 Resistance to water (Type II only). Writing (Prepare as specified in 3.1) shall be allowed to dry for 2 hours at room temperature. Immerse the paper for 24 hours in water. Remove the paper and let air dry. Examine for legibility.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

5. HAZARDOUS MATERIAL REQUIREMENTS.

5.1 Toxicity. Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the inks conforms to the above requirements.

5.2 Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

5.3 Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

6. QUALITY ASSURANCE REQUIREMENTS.

6.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see section 9), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

6.2 Lot definition. Each lot of inks shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall be expressed in inks manufactured from the same materials, at essentially the same time.

6.3 Examination of the end item for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one container of ink. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any container of ink containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

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Examine	Defects
Workmanship	See Workmanship paragraph
Material	Not as specified
Appearance	Spillage of ink or leakage on outside of the container. Container not clean.

6.4 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one container of ink. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any ink containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

Examine	Defects
Quantity	Not as specified
Fill of containers	Empty or broken containers; fill not as specified.

6.5 Sampling of end items for performance tests. Sampling for performance testing shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one ink. A random sample from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-1. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

6.5.1 Initial Performance Testing. The ink will be performance tested in accordance with paragraph 3.1 for each lot delivered.

6.6 Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section 7.

7. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

7.1 Unless otherwise specified (see section 9), preparation for delivery shall conform to normal commercial practice.

7.2 All packages shall be marked to show month and year of manufacture.

7.2.1 Packaging, and packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see section 9). The normal commercial number of unit packages shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box used commercially for this item. The complete pack shall be in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification. The weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

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7.2.2 Marking. Marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see section 9).

7.2.2.1 For Shipment To Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See section 9).

7.2.2.2 For Shipment To Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See section 9).

7.2.2.3 Additional marking. The unit and shipping containers shall include the date of manufacture and the date of reinspection (12 months after the date of manufacture) and the shipping containers, in addition, shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222, Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

8. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

8.1 Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations:

Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials

16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

8.2 National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W. Washington, D.C., 20036.

8.3 Uniform Classification Committee Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

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Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

8.4 Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions:

Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and Specification and Consumer Information Distribution Section, Building 197, Washington Navy Yard, Washington DC 20407.

Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)

FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

8.5 Military Standards:

Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Dept. Bldg. 4D 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

9. NOTES.

Ordering information. Purchasers should select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

9.1 Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
9.2 Purchasers shall indicate color of ink and size of container.
9.3 Purchasers should specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified
9.4 Purchasers should specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment, if other than required (See section 7).
9.5 Identification marking, if other than required.
9.6 If bar code marking is required.
9.7 MSDS's required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.

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9.8 Purchasers should specify palletization , if required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

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